

WOMEN SAFETY & SURVEILLANCE TRACK

BLOOM

Helping trusted adults learn, communicate, and guide girls through puberty and safety.

TEAM BLOOM

Christine Namatovu · Shakiran Nannyombi



Empowering Communities

Puberty is not only difficult for girls. Many adults don't know how to talk about it either.

1 in 10

young girls in sub-sharan Africa, puberty brings overwhelming questions about body changes, menstruation, personal boundaries, safety, and asking for help.

Uganda: puberty & reproductive-health teaching in schools remains patchy and rarely reaches rural areas.

Root Causes of Communication Barrier



Parents & Guardians

Grew up in environments where these conversations were surrounded by silence, shame, or deep discomfort.



Teachers

Often lack the formal training and confidence to answer sensitive questions when students approach them.



The Result

Girls are left without a single trusted adult they feel comfortable turning to during crucial developmental years.

The Communication Gap

The core issue is not just a lack of information, it is a lack of confident, safe conversations.



Girls

Struggle to ask questions due to shame or fear of disapproval.



Parents

Struggle to explain topics they were never taught how to discuss.



Teachers

Struggle to respond without standardized guidance or scripts.

"How do I even start this conversation with my child?"

A concerned parent wanting to help but feeling unprepared

"How do I handle sensitive questions from my students?"

A teacher facing unexpected puberty and safety inquiries

Why This Matters

When trusted adults cannot communicate, girls look elsewhere for guidance. This creates critical risks:

Unreliable Information

Girls depend on uninformed peers or unsafe online sources for answers to sensitive health questions.

Shame and Silence

Important questions about body changes remain completely unanswered, creating long-term anxiety.

Missed Safety Dialogues

Girls may fail to understand personal boundaries, body autonomy, or how to recognize grooming.

Isolation in Crisis

Girls facing abuse or difficult situations feel isolated and do not know which adult to approach for help.

Puberty education and safety should not depend on whether a girl happens to have access to a personal device.

Our Solution

INTRODUCING BLOOM

An AI-powered companion that equips trusted adults first.

Bloom provides the knowledge, language, and structured guidance needed to have conversations that many adults were never taught how to initiate.



Teachers

Equipped with ready-made lesson modules and classroom session guides.



Parents & Guardians

Supported with private pre-learning modules and home conversation starters.

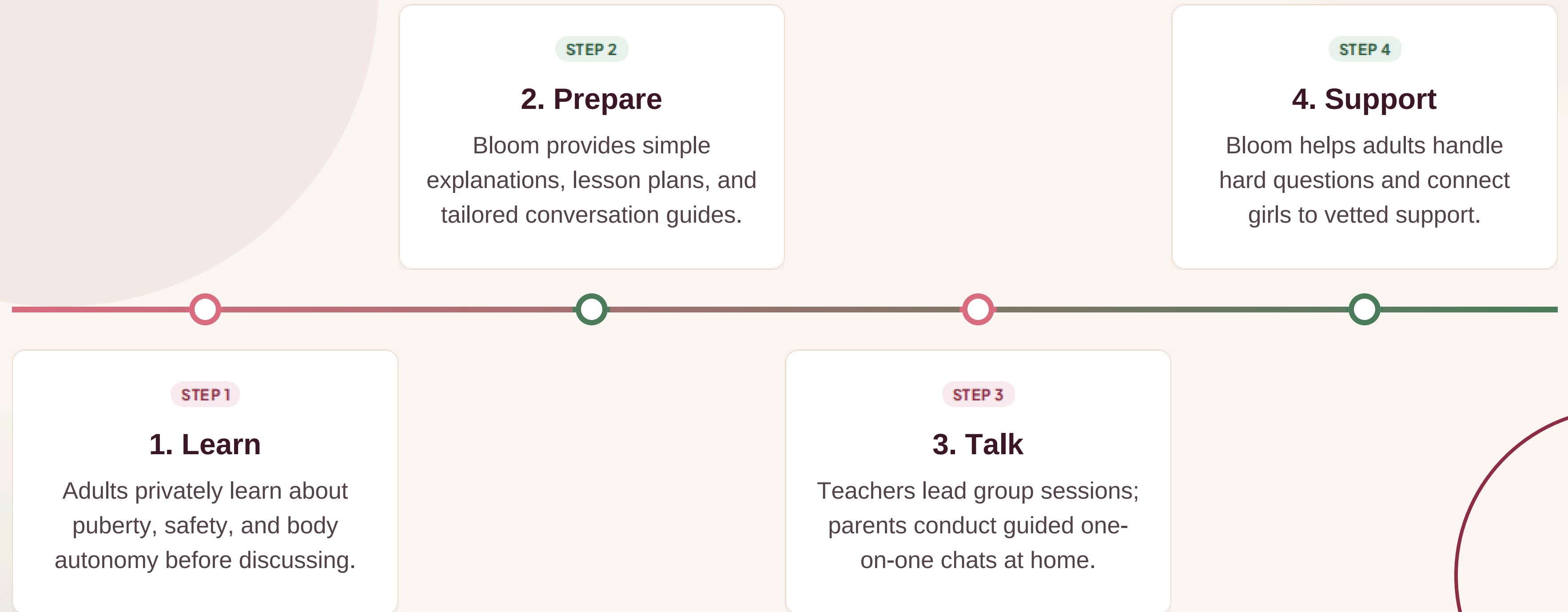


Community Facilitators

Provided with standardized scripts to lead local outreach groups confidently.

The Bloom Journey

A structured four-step methodology ensuring adult confidence before interaction:



Two Main User Journeys

Teacher Journey

Learn → Prepare → Teach → Ask AI → Support

- ✓ Access ready-made structured lessons
- ✓ Use talking points during classroom sessions
- ✓ Ask Bloom AI live, sensitive questions
- ✓ Receive private, real-time guidance
- ✓ Refer girls needing additional help to mentors

Parent/Gurdian Journey

Learn → Understand → Start Conversation → Guide → Support

- ✓ Learn privately before speaking to their child
- ✓ Understand physical & emotional body changes
- ✓ Get practical conversation starters
- ✓ Explain difficult topics simply without shame
- ✓ Ask Bloom AI questions without judgment

Learn Before You Talk

Many parents want to help — they just don't know how to begin. Bloom equips parents & guardians with:



Simple Modules

Understand puberty, menstruation, and safety topics privately before discussing them.



Conversation Starters

Simple, natural prompts to begin difficult conversations smoothly at home.



Common Questions

Prepares adults with simple answers to unexpected questions children ask.



Language Support

Complete culturally-adapted guidance available in both English and Luganda.



AI Parenting Guide

Provides private, judgment-free support for delicate questions, helping adults formulate empathetic responses.

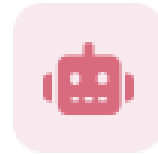
The Bloom Toolkit

One unified toolkit delivering specialized guidance for different settings:



Facilitator Toolkit

Ready-made lessons & talking points for teachers and community facilitators.



AI Co-Pilot

Live, judgment-free answers to complex questions raised during sessions.



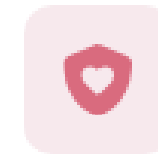
Conversation Guidance

Step-by-step guidance helping parents know exactly what to say.



Mentor Referral

Connects girls needing additional support directly with vetted near-peer mentors.



Safe Reporting

Private guidance for trusted adults responding to safety concerns or reporting risks.

How The AI Helps

Bloom AI strengthens adults it never replaces them.

Teacher asks: "How do I explain menstruation simply to my class?"

Parent asks: "How do I start a conversation about body safety with my daughter?"

- ✓ **Simple Explanations:** Clear, non-technical language
- ✓ **Age-Appropriate:** Tailored to the girl's growth stage
- ✓ **Bilingual Support:** Live guidance in English & Luganda



Safety By Design

Some conversations need more than information. Every sensitive query is handled with safety as the priority.



1. Private Guidance

Bloom provides private advice and response scripts directly to the trusted adult, not the child.



2. Vetted Mentors

The adult can connect the girl to a vetted near-peer mentor for ongoing 1-on-1 guidance.



3. Escalation Pathways

Serious safety concerns route to professional counsellors and approved support hotlines.

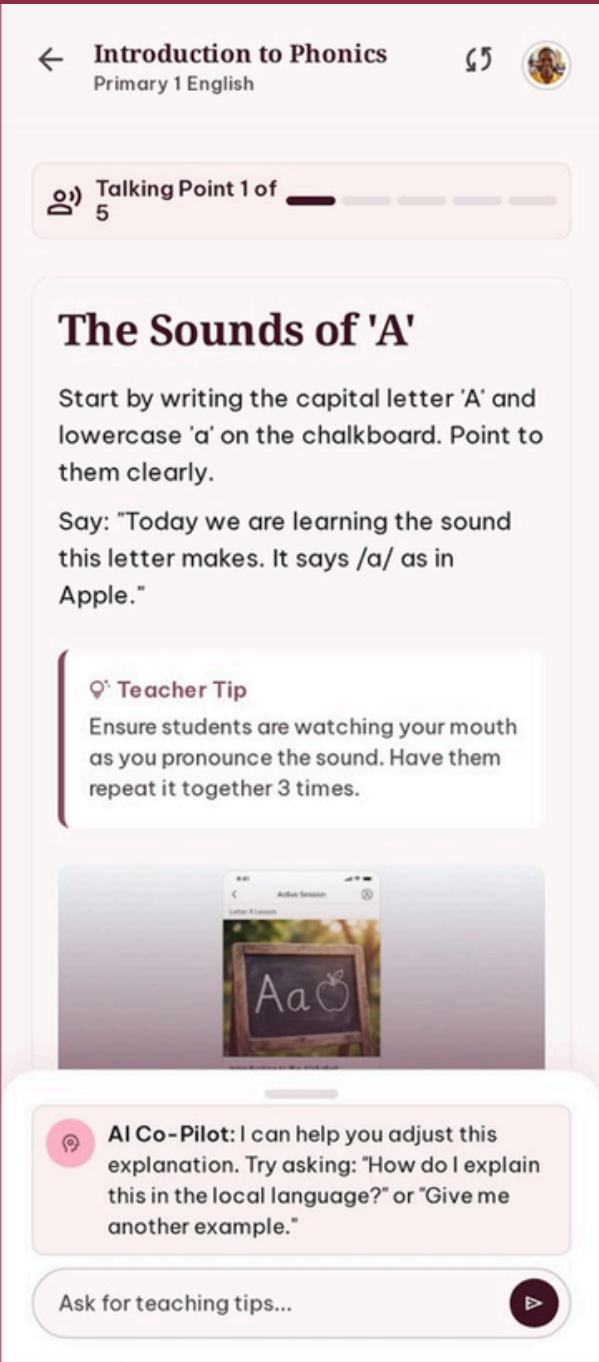
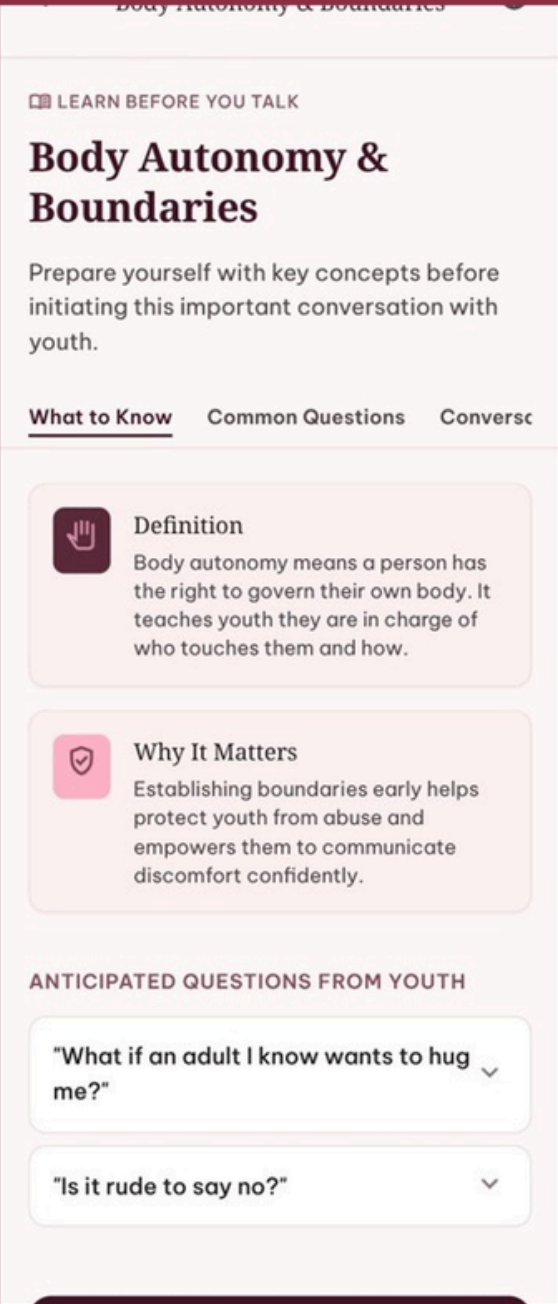
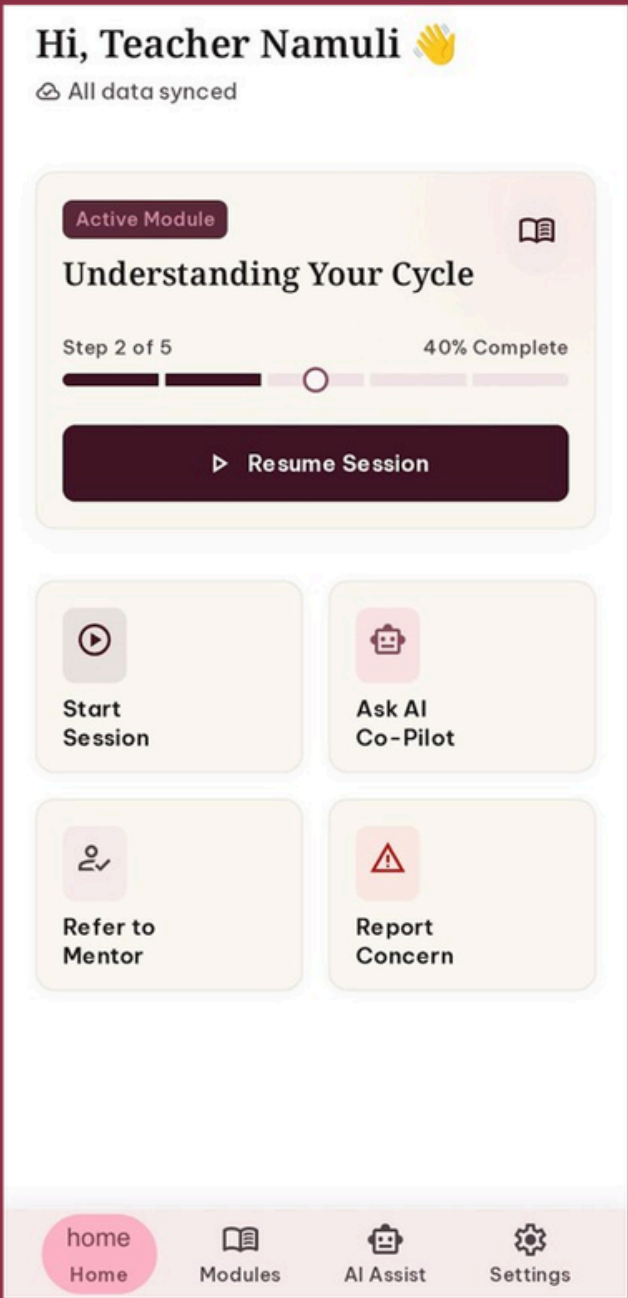
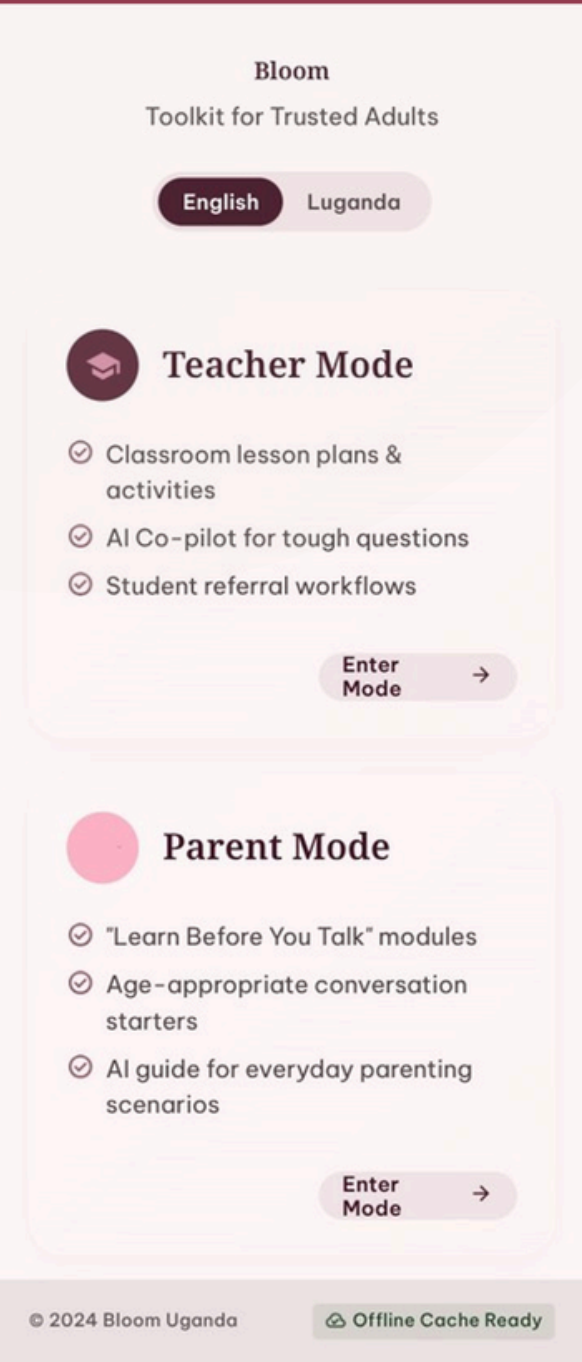
The girl is never left to navigate complex or dangerous situations alone.

Wireframes (Mobile View)

The application dynamically adapts based on whether the active user is a teacher or a parent/guardian:

General page(Parent/Teacher)

TEACHER INTERFACE



Execution Flow

Transforming uncertain adults into confident guides through 5 seamless steps:



System Architecture

Built for reliability: **One shared device** · **Multiple trusted adults** · **AI-guided support**

Facilitator Layer (Mobile App)

Flutter mobile app on shared device per school/household · Offline content caching · Lesson booklets & conversation scripts

API & Logic Layer

Node.js / Express REST API · Automated mentor-matching engine · User management & referral workflow handling

AI Layer

Safety-tuned AI model · Learning support & conversation guidance · Live Q&A & Luganda/English translation

Data Layer

PostgreSQL for user records & mentor databases · Firebase real-time sync · End-to-end encrypted storage

Why Bloom Is Different

We are not building another app that simply gives girls information.

We are strengthening the adults around them.

Bloom focuses directly on the adults girls already know and trust:

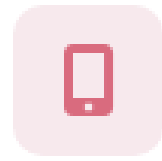
- ♥ **Parents & Guardians** at home
- ♥ **Teachers** in schools
- ♥ **Trusted Community Leaders**

Because sometimes the biggest barrier is not access to information, it is having someone confident enough to start the conversation.



Real World Impact

Designed for real community adoption, not just app download counts:



Equity by Design

One shared device supports an entire school grade, household, or community group without requiring individual smartphones.



Parents Included

Extends reach beyond the school classroom directly into domestic homes, breaking generational silence.



Language & Culture

Fully adapted for local cultural norms and regional languages, offering full English and Luganda support.



Offline Support

Learning modules and cached guides remain accessible even in remote areas with zero internet connectivity.

Pilot & Scale

A structured deployment approach: **Start local** · **Learn** · **Improve**
· **Scale**

PHASE 1

Pilot

Train teachers and parents in selected pilot schools and communities in Mbarara.

PHASE 2

Measure

Track sessions completed, parents trained, questions raised, and referrals handled safely.

PHASE 3

Expand

Build a wider network of partner schools, parents, mentors, and local NGOs (UNFPA Uganda).

LONG-TERM VISION

Mbarara Pilot → **Uganda National Network** → **East Africa**



"Every girl deserves more than information. She deserves trusted adults who are informed, confident, and ready to listen."

BLOOM

LEARN · TALK · GUIDE · SUPPORT

Women Safety & Surveillance Track

Team Bloom: Christine Namatovu · Shakiran Nannyombi